

APPS TO MAKE YOUR TRAVEL HASSLE-FREE



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Why do people travel? It is simple! Travel is food for the soul. It opens the mind to see the possibilities that lie ahead. It allows people to get out of their comfort zone and challenge themselves to try new things, learn new languages, escape from the routine, relax and rejuvenate, and celebrate life. The list is endless.

Whether you are a planner or an explorer, we have a list of apps that you can use to book tickets, find quick getaway options or rent a bike or car.

Lonely Planet Guides. This condensed, handy version of the popular books is packed with offline maps, audio phrase-books, currency converter and advice from on-the-ground experts. It is an ultimate resource for you before and during a trip.

Airbnb. A global travel community that offers end-to-end trips, including places to stay, things to do and people to meet, Airbnb empowers people around the world to open their spaces, passions and talents to become entrepreneurs in the hospitality industry. Airbnb's marketplace gives you access to unlimited places to stay in more than 150 countries, from apartments and villas to castles, treehouses and B&Bs. Using its Experiences feature, you can see a different side to a destination through handcrafted activities run by locals.

Travelyaari. This online bus booking portal makes even a bus journey pleasurable. It addresses usual bus tick-

eting problems such as uncomfortable journeys, unnecessary running around, and sudden bus or seat cancellations. Travelyaari.com is a 100 per cent real-time bus ticket inventory system. With this technology, you can view seats that are available. It prides itself as an enabler of the bus travel industry in India.

ConfirmTkt. This is an online train ticket discovery tool, which is trying to solve the pain points of Indian travellers with its data-driven travel solutions. ConfirmTkt solves the problem of waitlisting by predicting the waitlist train ticket confirmation chances based on historical trends and providing alternate travel options by utilising unused seats.

Skyscanner. Skyscanner is where you can plan and book flights and hotels, and even rent cars directly from millions of options at competitive prices.

Circa. This one comes in handy when you have travelled too much and have no idea what zone you are in. Circa helps you keep track of time (zones) across multiple locations, making it easier to plan interactions with friends, family or colleagues around the world.

AccuWeather. This app is great for international forecasting. It provides highly accurate hourly and minute-by-minute forecasts for any longitude/latitude on Earth, with customised content and engaging video presentations available on smartphones, tablets, connected televisions, radio and so on.

BlaBlaCar. BlaBlaCar is a long-distance carpooling platform. A trusted community marketplace, it connects car drivers with empty seats with passengers looking for a ride, over average distances of 300km. It has more than 60 million members in 22 countries, and serves more than 18 million travellers each quarter.

Last but not the least, there is Google Maps, available on all smartphones. It is the one app—apart from WhatsApp—that most people use almost every day. Use it to find hidden cafes along your travel routes to make your journey even more memorable.

Ella Maillart rightly said, "One travels to run away from routine, that dreadful routine that kills all imagination and all our capacity for enthusiasm." **EFY**